Certified Personal Trainer

DOMAIN SIX

PROFESSIONAL PRACTICE AND RESPONSIBILITY

EXAM WEIGHT 10%

ISSA INTERNATIONAL SPORTS SCIENCES ASSOCIATION

Like all professionals, Certified Personal Trainers have certain personal and professional guidelines that should be followed. In addition, having a strong understanding of how to build, manage, and grow a personal training business is a critical element in a personal trainer's success.

Code of Ethics - Chapter 18

The code of ethics covers standards from each of these five categories:

- Integrity: being straightforward, honest, and transparent
- Objectivity: remaining unprejudiced and avoiding conflict, bias, or outside influence
- Professional competence: committing to education and professional knowledge to improve coaching skills throughout one's career
- Confidentiality: protecting the privacy of clients in all forms
- Professional behavior: acting to build and preserve one's reputation as a health coaching professional

ISSA CODE OF ETHICS

The ISSA Certified Personal Trainer shall do the following:

- Act with integrity in relationships with colleagues, peers, and other health care professionals
- Maintain a professional client-trainer relationship at all times; personal training professionals have the obligation to properly assess clients, program for their needs, educate them, and provide health care referrals (as needed) for their best interest
- Refrain from soliciting business from another professional's clients or students
- Respect the client's choices and decisions about their own health and provide accurate, factual information
- Truthfully represent their education or credential(s) to ISSA, clients, or an employer and work inside their scope of practice
- Not discriminate on the basis of sex, gender, race, religion, national origin, color, or any other basis deemed illegal
- Maintain any and all primary and supplementary certifications (including CPR certification, as required) that are necessary to execute their job
- Uphold their social responsibility to promote diversity and inclusion, and educate and inform within the scope of practice
- Use their best judgment to maintain a safe training environment for clients; this includes the space being used and the recommendations being offered—at no time shall harm to others be intended
- Accurately represent their services and what is reasonably expected from a training relationship with clients
- Keep up to date on new developments, concepts, and practices in the wellness industry to promote professional excellence
- Maintain a strict level of privacy and confidentiality with patient information and programs
- Maintain a clean appearance that is consistent with good hygiene and appropriate working attire

CPR/AED - Chapter 19

It is a basic requirement for a Certified Personal Trainer to have a certification in cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR) which is often combined with training on how to use an automated external defibrillator (AED).

- Cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR): an emergency procedure involving chest compressions and, often, artificial ventilation to circulate blood and preserve brain function in an individual in cardiac arrest
- Automated external defibrillator (AED): a portable electronic device that can identify and electrically correct heart arrhythmias, ventricular fibrillation, and tachycardia

Scope of Practice - Chapter 2

Throughout their careers, trainers will come across various scenarios that may be outside their scope of practice. This is not a comprehensive list, but the following are common conditions that are present in the personal training setting:

- Injuries
- Medical concerns
- Eating disorders
- Mental illness, including depression
- Specific meal planning

If a personal trainer encounters a client or potential client with any of these conditions, they should not give advice or make a diagnosis but refer them to the appropriate professional.

Personal Training Business - Chapter 18

- Common styles of training
  - In-person training: live, face-to-face fitness training done individually or in small or large groups
  - Virtual training: remote training sessions conducted via a website, phone applications, or social media platforms
  - Hybrid training: a training approach that utilizes in-person and virtual training styles to allow for easier, more frequent access to the fitness professional
  - Buddy training: exercise instruction between a personal trainer and two clients at the same time
  - Small group personal training: exercise instruction delivered to two to four clients at the same time
    - Reduces cost for the participants
  - Group exercise: large group training that is often choreographed and where all participants are executing the same exercises simultaneously
    - Large group training = 20 to 50 participants and possibly beyond
- Four primary business structures
  - Sole proprietorship: the most common business structure; a single owner has complete control over and liability for a business

- Partnership: two or more people run the business, sharing liability and responsibility for the business's performance
- Limited liability company (LLC): limits the liability of the owner; combines aspects of corporations and sole proprietorships
- Corporation: owners and operators are separated from the liabilities of the business
  - C corporations: the business itself is liable for the tax burdens of financial losses and gains of the corporation
  - S corporations: the shareholders are responsible for the tax burdens of losses and gains

- Business plans
  - Purpose: To outline how a business will be operated
  - Business plans (traditional or lean) should include the following:
    - Mission statement: a short statement of why a business exists and its overall goal for operating
    - Market analysis: a qualitative and quantitative assessment of a business market that examines product and service volume, buying patterns, regulations, and business competition
    - Target market: the particular group(s) of consumers that a product or service targets
      - Client persona: a fictional person that represents the key characteristics of a trainer's preferred clientele
        - Is this person male or female?
        - How old is this person?
        - What does this person do for a living?
        - How much money does this person make?
        - Is this person a parent?
        - What is this person's current fitness level?
        - What is this person's goal? To increase strength? Lose fat? Train for an event?
        - What are this person's biggest challenges?
    - Customer life cycle: the steps a customer goes through when considering, buying, and using a product or service; includes awareness, engagement, evaluation, purchase, experience, and bonding and advocacy
      - Attract new potential clients
      - Capture leads
      - Nurture and convert leads
      - Create value
        - What is the tangible value of working with a trainer?
        - What are the issues working with a trainer helps solve?
      - Initial assessment
      - Deliver services
      - Upsell Clients
        - A sales technique where a client is encouraged to purchase additional services, products, or add-ons to generate more revenue

- Follow-up assessment
- Get client referrals
  - Client referrals: a method of marketing where current or former clients refer friends and family to a professional for services by word of mouth
  - The most effective way for a trainer to find new prospects
  - People are most excited about a trainer's services when they are seeing results and making effective lifestyle changes
  - Some trainers find success in offering rewards for referrals
  - Quick follow-up with referrals is essential to act on interest in the moment

Best Practices - Chapter 18

There is more to personal training than just subject matter expertise. Other pieces of knowledge, skills, and abilities lend themselves to career success in this field.

- Be organized and use a scheduling tool
  - Phone apps, websites
- Be clear with expectations and policies
  - Cancellation policy
  - No show policy
- Track client results
  - Helps trainer make the appropriate modifications
  - Helps clients see their progress
- Be on time
  - Be early
  - Be prepared in advance
  - End training sessions on time
- Meet and nurture leads
  - Follow-up with leads
    - Email marketing
      - 2-3 emails a week
      - Ideal email length: 50-125 words
      - Use different types of emails
        - Relationship emails: emails used to engage with clients and prospects and build a relationship
        - Strategic emails: email communications that explain why a trainer does what they do, training philosophies, and more about themselves

            - Promotional emails: an email communication series that presents an offer or promotion for a limited time
            - Onboarding emails: a series of email communications that gather the required documentation and assessments to begin a training program
            - Reengagement emails: an email communication method to reach out to former clients and prospects and encourage a reply
        - Social media
            - YouTube
            - LinkedIn
            - Pinterest
            - Instagram
            - Facebook
            - Snapchat
            - TikTok
        - Positive, shareable marketing material
            - Testimonials or success stories (social proof)
            - Before and after photos
    - Collaborate with influential people who have a similar target market
        - Hairstylists
        - Chiropractors
        - Physical therapists
        - Nutritionists
    - Find effective and easy ways to communicate with and manage current clients
- Practice self-care
    - Live a lifestyle that includes a healthy personal exercise practice, proper nutrition, and adequate rest and recovery
- Invest in continuing education and personal development
    - Pursue additional courses or workshops
    - Specialize in a niche
- Personalizing the training experience
    - Acknowledge special occasions
        - Birthdays or holidays (special themed workouts, birthday cards)
        - 100 sessions completed
        - Achieving a goal
- Maintain appropriate relationship boundaries
    - Establish appropriate avenues and times for client communication
    - Be mindful of discussing sensitive or personal subjects

- Be clear about and enforce established policies
- Stay within the scope of practice
- Maintain appropriate levels of privacy if sharing personal life details

Safety and Emergency Situations - Chapter 19

Under no circumstances does ISSA accept responsibility regarding any consequences that stem from the use of the information provided in this section.

The following information is provided as a study aid and is not intended for use as a first-aid manual. The following information is intended as information for safety awareness and is in no way to be used as a substitute for CPR, AED, or first aid training; OSHA compliance; job training; or for proper equipment use.

- Own the floor
  - Keep all equipment clean
    - Cleaning: removing dirt and impurities from surfaces or objects with a detergent (like soap) and water; does NOT kill germs but it removes them and lowers the risk of spreading infection
    - Disinfecting: killing germs and viruses on surfaces or objects with the use of chemicals; does not necessarily remove the germs from the surface when it kills them but it lowers the risk of infection
    - Sanitizing: cleaning and killing germs on surfaces or objects enough to bring the microbe level to an acceptable range
  - Ensure all equipment is in working order
    - Torn fabrics
    - Broken dumbbells
    - Frayed cable coverings
  - Properly store equipment that is not in use
    - Small equipment put away
    - Weight plates on appropriate weight trees
- Injury support and prevention
  - Teach proper warm-up, proper cooldown, and proper form
  - First aid kit: a compact box that is pre-stocked with supplies for triage and general medical interventions
  - Emergency exit plan: a visual plan of how and where to exit a space in the event of an emergency
    - Includes a drawn floor plan of the space
    - Clearly labels all exit and entry doors, stairwells, and elevators
    - Visually identifies the location of the viewer on the floor plan
    - Clearly identifies exit routes from the current location
    - Identifies where to go in case elevators are not operational (if applicable)
    - Clearly identifies a designated meeting place outside of or away from the facility or space

- Safety supplies
  - Disposable gloves
  - Fire extinguisher
  - Towels
  - Sanitizing solutions
- Incident Reporting
  - Person's name
  - Contact information
  - Injury or illness
  - How the injury occurred
  - Site of incident
  - Witnesses and their contact information

- First aid situations
  - Blisters
  - Fainting
  - Hypoglycemia (low blood sugar)
  - Flu or fever
  - Heat cramps
  - Contusion (bruise)
  - Shock
    - An acute medical condition brought on by a sudden drop in blood flow and blood pressure through the body
  - RICE
    - Rest
    - Ice
    - Compress
    - Elevate
- Fractures, sprains, strains, and dislocations
  - First aid treatment of any of these conditions should be treated as though they were a fracture
  - Signs and symptoms
    - Grating sensation of bones rubbing together
    - Pain
    - Tenderness
    - Swelling
    - Bruising
    - Inability to move the injured body part

- Sprains
  - Injuries to the connective tissue in a joint or group of joints
  - The ankle and wrist are common locations
- Diabetic Emergencies
  - Insulin shock: a medical condition caused by too much insulin in the body that results in stark drops in blood glucose
  - Diabetic coma: a comatose state resulting from excessively high blood sugar levels
- Emergency (call 911)
  - Chest pain; specifically, chest pain lasting more than a few minutes
  - Loss of consciousness for any reason; a medical professional can help determine the underlying cause
  - Shortness of breath; especially when it occurs abruptly; seek medical help right away to determine the cause and prevent further complications
  - Head Injuries; can range from mild to severe and may cause concussions; contact help, especially if accompanied with other symptoms like seizure, headache, nausea or vomiting, slurred speech, confusion, weakness, or a loss of coordination
  - Broken bones; more than basic first aid cannot be offered by anyone other than a medical professional for broken bones
  - Heart conditions; heart attack or arrhythmias that cause chest pain, loss of consciousness, or shortness of breath should be attended to by a medical professional
  - Abnormal vision or dizziness; blurry vision, double vision, and loss of vision may be symptoms of a more serious medical condition
  - Vomiting; if there is blood in the vomit or it is accompanied by other symptoms like a headache, abdominal pain, or a fast heart rate, it can be a symptom of a greater condition
  - Deep cuts; more severe cuts and lacerations will need to be closed with sutures and may affect major blood vessels
  - Severe abdominal pain; a medical professional needs to determine the cause, which could be as simple as gas or as serious as an inflamed or ruptured appendix, the latter of which would require an operation immediately
- Liability insurance
  - Insurance that protects the trainer financially if a client were to open a lawsuit due to a fitness accident
    - This coverage is necessary for a trainer who is self-employed and owns their own business